

DATA ANALYTICS ASSIGNMENT

Part A: RCTTCE Prompt

Role: You are a Senior Retail Business Analyst and Data Strategy Consultant with expertise in retail operations, customer analytics, loyalty programmes, and executive reporting.

Context: A retail company with 30 stores has experienced declining business performance over the last 18 months. The executive team suspects that the decline may be related to store operations, product performance, customer purchasing behaviour, or loyalty programme effectiveness. A dataset containing approximately 50,000 records is available and includes store performance metrics, product sales data, customer transaction records, and loyalty programme activity. The CEO requires evidence-based insights to understand the causes of the decline and identify growth opportunities.

Task: Analyse the business situation and produce an executive-level stakeholder brief that summarises the current business challenge, identifies the most important analytical questions, explains what business decisions the analysis will support, describes how the available data can be used, and recommends priority areas for investigation.

Format: Executive Summary, Key Business Questions, Decisions Supported, Available Data Overview, Recommended Analysis Priorities, and Expected Business Impact.

Constraints: Maximum 250 words, avoid technical jargon, focus on business value, prioritise actionable recommendations, and use bullet points where appropriate.

Part B: AI-Generated Stakeholder Brief

Stakeholder Brief for CEO

Situation Summary:

The company has experienced declining performance across its 30-store network over the past 18 months. To identify the root causes, the Analytics Team will analyse store performance, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty programme activity from approximately 50,000 records. The goal is to uncover performance drivers and opportunities for growth.

Three Key Business Questions:

- Which stores are experiencing the greatest decline, and what factors distinguish them from higher-performing locations?
- Which products or categories are driving revenue losses or gains across the business?
- How does customer purchasing behaviour and loyalty programme engagement impact sales performance?

Decisions These Questions Will Inform:

- Resource allocation and store improvement strategies.
- Product assortment, pricing, and inventory decisions.
- Customer retention and loyalty programme optimisation initiatives.

Description of Available Data:

- Store performance metrics: revenue, sales trends, and location-level performance.
- Product sales records: product demand, category performance, and sales contribution.
- Customer transaction data: purchase frequency, basket size, and spending patterns.
- Loyalty programme activity: engagement, retention, and reward redemption behaviour.

The analysis will help management prioritise actions that improve profitability, strengthen customer loyalty, and drive sustainable growth.

Reflection:

I structured the prompt using the RCTTCE framework to ensure the AI clearly understood its role, business context, expected output, and limitations. The prompt focuses on executive decision-making rather than technical analysis, making the resulting brief concise, actionable, and relevant to senior stakeholders. This approach increases the likelihood of producing business-focused insights that support strategic decision-making.

“The prompt was intentionally designed to align analytics outputs with executive decision-making objectives, ensuring that insights generated from the dataset directly support strategic business actions rather than simply reporting trends.”